Baked Feta Pasta

DAIRY

Prep — Cook **35 min** Total **35 min** Serves —



Ingredients

- **2 pints** cherry tomatoes
- **3** garlic cloves, halved (we mince it)
- olive oil
- **8 oz** feta
- **1 tsp** salt (does not need salt)
- ⅓ **tsp** pepper
- **16 oz** rigatoni or other short pasta
- chopped basil

Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees.
2. In a 13 x 9 in. baking dish, combine 2 pints cherry tomatoes, 3 halved garlic cloves and ¼ cup olive oil.
3. Place 8 oz feta in center, moving tomatoes so cheese sits on pan bottom.
4. Drizzle feta with another ¼ cup olive oil; sprinkle with 1 tsp salt and ¼ tsp pepper (we also put red pepper flakes, basil, oregano, etc).
5. Bake until tomatoes split and garlic softens, 30-40 minutes.
6. Meanwhile, cook 16 oz. rigatoni or other short pasta according to package directions for al dente.
7. Drain, reserving 1 cup pasta water. Stir feta mixture, lightly pressing tomatoes, until combined. Add pasta; toss to combine. Stir in enough reserved pasta water to achieve desired consistency.
8. Sprinkle with coarsely chopped basil.